BEING FILLED WITH THE SPIRIT

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I. Greek Terminology for Being Filled with the Holy Spirit

A. Several pertinent words not used of being filled with the Holy Spirit are γεμίζω (*gemízō*), ἐμπιπλάω (*empipláō*), ἐμπίμπλημι (*empímplēmi*), κεράννυμι (*keránnymi*, κεπάω, *kepáō*], μεστόω (*mestóō*), πλήρωμα (*plērōma*), συμπληρόω (*symplēróō*), ἀναπληρόω (*anaplēróō*), χορτάζω (*chortázō*, be filled with food), ἀνταναπληρόω (*antanaplēróō*), τελέω (*teléō*, fill by finishing).

B. Πίμπλημι (*pímplēmi*)

1. Luke **1**:15: *"He [John the Baptist] will be filled with the Holy Spirit from his mother's womb."*
2. Luke **1**:41: *"Elizabeth was filled with the Holy Spirit and she lifted up her voice. . . ."*
3. Luke **1**:67: *"Zacharias was filled with the Holy Spirit and prophesied saying . . ."*
4. Acts **2**:4: *"And they [apostles] were all filled with the Holy Spirit . . . and they began to speak. . . ."*
5. Acts **4**:8: *"Then Peter, filled with the Holy Spirit, said . . ."*
6. Acts **4**:31: *"And they were filled with the Holy Spirit and spoke the word of the Lord with boldness."*
7. Acts **9**:17: *"And be [Paul] filled with the Holy Spirit . . ."*
8. Acts **13**:9: *"But Paul . . . filled with the Holy Spirit and said . . ."*
9. Note also filled with fear (Luke **5:**26), madness/rage (Luke **6**:11), wonder and amazement (Acts **3**:10), indignation (Acts **5**:17), envy (Acts **5**:17; **13**:45), (city filled with) confusion (Acts **19**:29).

C. Πληρόω (*plēróō*)

1. Ephesians **5**:18: *". . . but be filled [present imperative] with the Spirit."*
2. Note Acts **5**:3: *"Ananias, why has Satan filled your heart to lie to the Holy Spirit?"*
3. Note also "filled with comfort" (2 Corinthians **7**:4), covetousness (Romans **1**:29), the fullness of God (Ephesians **3**:19), the fruits of righteousness (Philippians **1**:11), joy/gladness (Acts **2**:28; **13**:52; Romans **15**:13; Philippians **2**:2; 2 Timothy **1**:4; 1 John **1**:4; 2 John 12), knowledge (Romans **15**:14; Colossians **1**:9), maliciousness (Romans **1**:29), obedience (2 Corinthians **10**:6), peace (Acts **13**:52), sorrow (John **16**:6), understanding (Colossians **1**:9), unrighteousness (Romans **1**:29), wickedness (Romans **1**:29), wisdom (Luke **2**:40; Colossians **1**:9). Note also *"your joy may be full"* (John **3**:29; **15**:11; **16**:6, 24).

II. Observations on the Data

A. Except for Ephesians **5**:18, the filling imagery for the Spirit occurs only in Lucan materials. Luke is virtually alone in using the expression *"filled with the Spirit."* Paul is alone in using the expression *"earnest* (and "seal") *of the Spirit."* John the Baptist is alone in using the term *"baptism in the Holy Spirit."* Terminology peculiar to one writer does not likely refer to something distinctive. He is not likely the only writer to be talking about that part of the picture. Other writers probably talk about the same thing with different word pictures. So, we do not look for a different thing every time we see a different expression.

B. Except in Luke **1**:15, πίμπλημι refers to an on-the-spot drive to action.

C. Πληρόω (*plēróō*) connotes a more stative idea, although Acts **5**:3 may be a response to a situation.

D. Ephesians **5**:18, being present imperative, is a characteristic filling rather than a special one. This passage is the only one in the imperative. Since a person can be commanded to be filled, the person determines whether it occurs.

Ephesians **5**:18 should not be taken to mean that being filled with the Spirit is comparable to being drunk. In fact, being filled with the Spirit and being drunk are opposites—replacing one another—as in **5**:4, *"Let there be no filthiness, nor silly talk, nor levity (which are not fitting), but instead let there be thanksgiving."*

E. There is seemingly a conceptual connection between indwelling and filling in the characteristic sense. The first pictures ongoing personal association; the second pictures that association as complete—"full." "Being filled the Spirit" connects the imagery with actions prompted by that complete "filling."

III. Ideas Expressed Under the Filling-with-the-Spirit Imagery.

A. Establishment of the basic interpersonal relationship with the Holy Spirit
B. Increase in the general life quality
C. Surges of boldness to act
D. Special enablement to prophesy supernaturally

IV. Other Things People Are Filled with in the New Testament (See also I, B 9; and I, C 3 above.)

A. μεστόω (*mestóō*): <u>new wine</u> (Acts **2**:13)
B. ἐμπιπλάω (*empipláō*): <u>food</u> (Luke **1**:53; John **6**:12; cp. Luke **6**:25), <u>company</u> (Romans **15**:24)
C. ἐμπιπλάω (*empliplaō*): <u>food</u> and <u>gladness of heart</u> (Acts **14**:17)
D. γεμίζω (*gemízō*): <u>carob pods</u> (<u>husks</u>; Luke **15**:16)
E. χορτάζω (*chortázō*): <u>food</u> (Matthew **5**:6; **14**:20; **15**:33, 37; Mark **6**:42; **7**:27; **8**:4, 8; Luke **9**:17; **15**:16; **16**:21; John **6**:26; James **2**:16)
F. μεστός (*mestós*): <u>hypocrisy</u> (Matthew **23**:28); <u>envy</u>, <u>murder</u>, <u>strife</u>, <u>malignity</u> (Romans **1**:29); <u>goodness</u> (Romans **15**:14); <u>adultery</u> (2 Peter **2**:14)

V. What People Are Filled with in the Old Testament

A. Spirit of God: Exodus **31**:3; **35**:31; Micah **3**:8

B. (The spirit of) wisdom/understanding/knowledge: Deuteronomy **34**:9; 1 Kings **7**:13- 14; Proverbs **24**:3-4

C. Feelings: anger (Esther **5**:9; Isaiah **51**:20); anguish (Isaiah **21**:3; bitterness (Lamentations **3**:15); joy (Psalm **16**:11); contempt (Psalm **123**:4); indignation (Jeremiah **15**:17); shame (Habakkuk **2**:16); sorrow (Ezekiel **23**:33)

D. Skill: Exodus **35**:34-35

E. Behaviors: adultery (Proverbs **7**:18); drunkenness (Jeremiah **13**:13; Ezekiel **23**:33); laughter (Job **8**:21; Psalm **126**:2); rebuke (Isaiah **51**:20); reproach (Lamentations **3**:30); scoffing (Psalm **123**:4); singing (Psalm **126**:2)

F. Glory: Habakkuk **2**:16

G. Physical things: food (Nehemiah **9**:25; Job **20**:23; Psalm **78**:29)

H. Qualities: burning (Psalm **38**:7); goodness (Jeremiah **31**:14); sin (Proverbs **12**:21; **14**:14; Ecclesiastes **8**:11); youth (Job **20**:11)

As the above data on vocabulary show, "filling" imagery applies to virtually anything notable: feelings, qualities, behaviors, abilities, conditions, as well as substantive contents. So, being filled with the Spirit is an image for being notably characterized by the Spirit's interpersonal presence and influence.